



vides green and sustainable biomass solutions, shared the story of its journey as well.

The Adani Group has worked with several startups in the past. The Group supported iKure, a health-care innovator that provided services in the Sundarbans area of West Bengal. It has also worked with prosthetics technologist, RoboBionics, and dharavimarket.com, which focuses on the holistic development of craftsmen and residents of Dharavi in Mumbai.

The first edition of 'Green Talks' was organised in 2021 and the second edition in 2022. The Adani Prize for Social Enterprise was announced to be awarded to five outstanding social entrepreneurs for their impact in India and other parts of the developing world. The prize was a total of Rs 5 crores in funding to support the chosen social enterprises.

'Green Talks' strives to bring together social enterprises that are working towards broad transformation in various sectors. It has been designed as a space for open-source innovation, a forum for discussion, and an incubator for concepts that have the potential to bring about long-lasting change. It believes in an entrepreneur's ability to harness technology, design, and innovation for the larger good.

International Day for Persons with Disabilities: Overcoming hurdles

At an event organised to mark the International Day for Persons with Disabilities, several individuals with disabilities, who are role models themselves, shared their life stories. The speakers were at the Green X Talks orga-



nized by the Adani Group on December 4. They shared their stories of struggle and how they continue to overcome multiple challenges with resilience, dedication, and determination.

Ajay Kumar Reddy, captain of the Indian men's blind cricket team since 2016, was at the event and shared some of his life experiences. Reddy led the team that won the 2017 Blind T20 World Cup and the 2018 Blind Cricket World Cup.

Nipun Malhotra, a disability rights activist and social entrepreneur who has a bachelor's degree in economics from St. Stephens, Delhi, also spoke at the event. Malhotra went on to complete his master's in economics from Delhi University. The CEO of Nipman Foundation, a disability rights advocacy organisation, and founder of Wheels for Life, he had to struggle with accessibility

challenges in public places, including educational institutions. He was a chair at the disability sub-committee of NITI Aayog, a visiting research fellow at World Enabled and an external expert on Diversity, Equity and Inclusion at the Boston Consulting Group. Malhotra is also the founder chair of FICCI's disability subcommittee, a World Economic Forum (WEF) Global Shaper and a CII National Committee member. Four panelists held a discussion on accessibility and inclusivity at the workplace. Tarun Kumar Vashisth, a professor at Panjab University, who is the first Ph.D candidate with visual impairment at IIM-A, and Alina Alam, who started Mitti Café in 2017, were among the speakers. Currently, Mitti Café employs 400-odd people with various kinds of disabilities.

Among the panelists was Dr. Anita Sharma, India's first woman skydiver with disability. She is paralysed from the waist down due to polio. Dr. Sharma did her Ph.D on disability and entrepreneurship from IIM-Indore. The founder of 'Drive On My Own' Foundation and Inkpothub, she is also a diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI) consultant.

Dr. Bhushan Punani, general secretary, Blind Association, and an IIM- Ahmedabad alumnus, was the fourth panelist. He is also a Vice-President of the International Council for Education of People with Visual Impairment. Rashmi Patil, a bharatnatyam dancer with hearing impairment, performed at the inaugural segment. The event ended with songs by Ankita Patel, who has visual impairment. She has been a professional singer for five years.